

User Type	User Demographics	User Habits	Problems & Needs
Undergraduate course-file student (primary user)	• 18–24 years old • Full-time U of R undergraduate, mostly 2nd–4th year engineering, science and business • Education level: in progress toward a bachelor’s degree • Laptop plus phone; a large share also own an iPad • Limited budget — part-time work or student loans, sensitive to subscription pricing	• Studies in 1–3 hour blocks between and after classes, often late evening • Works from lecture slides and textbook PDFs downloaded from UR Courses into per-course folders and Downloads • Annotates on an iPad (Goodnotes, Notability) or reads on a laptop • Already asks ChatGPT for explanations and watches YouTube walkthroughs • Study effort concentrates in the days before midterms and finals	• Re-supplying the same material as context at the start of each session • Explanations that are not anchored to the page being read • No fast way to check understanding right after reading • Review happens under exam pressure instead of on a plan • Wants course material to stay on the device
Graduate and thesis student (secondary user)	• 22–30 years old • MSc, PhD and senior thesis students, plus research assistants • Education level: holds a bachelor’s degree, working on a graduate degree • Laptop-centred, frequently with an external monitor • Funded by assistantship or scholarship; may be able to expense software	• Reads a high volume of papers weekly, skimming first and deep-reading a few • Maintains a reference library (Zotero, Mendeley) and a folder of PDFs per topic • Writes while reading and needs to attribute claims to a source • Returns to the same papers months later	• Recall across many documents, not only the one currently open • Summaries accurate enough to cite • Keeping unpublished and licensed material off third-party servers • Finding the passage that supports a half-remembered claim
Design partner student (research participant)	• 18–25 years old • U of R undergraduates recruited from classmates across mixed programs • Mixed devices: Windows laptop, Mac, iPad • Same student budget as the primary group	• Willing to try a new tool if it takes minutes to set up • Gives feedback in short sessions between classes • Tests on their own real course material rather than a demo set • Compares anything new against ChatGPT and Goodnotes, which they already use	• Setup must take minutes, not an evening • Must work with their real files and folder structure • Needs to see a learning benefit before switching from current tools • Wants a clear statement of what leaves the device before using their own coursework